

1. Birth Asphyxia (The Baby Doesn't Breathe or Breathes Poorly)

The Most Immediate Killer

- **Why it's fatal:** The baby's brain and organs are starved of oxygen. This can cause death or severe brain damage within minutes.
- **Signs to Recognize (Within the first minute after birth):**
 - The baby is **not crying** or breathing.
 - The baby is **limp, blue, or pale**.
 - Gasping or very weak, irregular breathing.

2. Preterm Birth / Low Birth Weight (Born Too Early or Too Small)

A Vulnerable Newborn

- **Why it's fatal:** The baby's organs (lungs, brain, liver) are underdeveloped. They are at extreme risk for:
 - **Inability to maintain body temperature** (hypothermia).
 - **Severe infections** (sepsis).
 - **Breathing problems** (Respiratory Distress Syndrome).
- **Signs to Recognize:**
 - The baby is **very small** or looks tiny and frail.
 - The skin is **thin, shiny, and translucent**.
 - Weak cry or difficulty breathing.

3. Severe Infection (Neonatal Sepsis)

A Rapid and Silent Killer

- **Why it's fatal:** A newborn's immune system is very weak. An infection can enter the bloodstream and become fatal within hours.
- **Signs to Recognize (The baby was initially well but then shows these signs within the first week):**
 - **Feels cold** (hypothermia) - the baby's stomach feels cold to touch, NOT the hands/feet.
 - **Not feeding well** or refusing to breastfeed.
 - **Lethargic or unconscious** (the baby is unusually sleepy, floppy, and difficult to wake).

- **Fits or convulsions.**
- **Fast breathing** or grunting.

4. Birth Defects (Compatible with Life) Requiring Immediate Surgery

Some defects are not immediately fatal but will be if not treated urgently.

- **Signs to Recognize:**

- **Breathing Difficulty:** If the baby has a **cleft lip/palate** and is choking or unable to feed.
- **No Bowel Movement:** If the baby has no meconium (first black stool) within 24 hours and has a **distended abdomen** (could be intestinal blockage).
- **Spina Bifida:** An open sore or sac on the baby's back.